need to address the issues of transnational threats encompassing narco-terrorism, arms running and sea piracy. The IOR-ARC must also beef-up cooperation for providing assistance during natural disasters such as cyclones, famines, Tsunamis which can be dubbed as “out of area operations.” The Tenth Council of Ministers Meeting held on 5 August 2010 at Yemen, emphasized cooperation among IOR-ARC members in the areas like promotion of trade and investment, tourism, culture, education, combating communicable diseases and natural disasters and challenges of Climate Change. They also agreed to take up initiatives for combating piracy in the Gulf of Aden and other parts of Indian Ocean. India has assumed the Chair of IOR-ARC from 2011.

The12th Meeting of the Council of Ministers of IOR-ARC was hosted by India. ***The Gurgaon Communiqué-IORARC at 15—The Next Decade*** underlined the geo-strategic importance of the Indian Ocean and garner the capabilities at hand of the Rim countries to meet common challenges. They reaffirmed the maintenance of freedom of navigation and safety and security of Sea Lanes of Communication the Indian Ocean as piracy is a growing threat and also pledged to fight natural disasters in the IOR-ARC maritime domain. Union of Comoros was inducted into the IOR-ARC as the twentieth member of the Association. The members of IOR-ARC also have agreed to admit the United States of America as the 6$^{th}$ Dialogue Partner of IOR-ARC.

Currently the name of this regional bloc has been changed to **Indian Ocean Rim Association (IORA).**

The Government of Mauritius in collaboration with the Indian Ocean Rim Association hosted the First IORA Ministerial Blue Economy Conference on the theme “Enhancing Blue Economy Cooperation for Sustainable Development in the IORA Region”, at Le Meridien, Pointe aux Piments, Republic of Mauritius from 2-3 September 2015.

The Council of Ministers’ Meeting of IORA on 6-9 October 2014 in Perth, Australia adopted the Blue Economy as the top priority for generating employment and ensuring sustainability in business and economic models. An IORA Secretariat draft paper identified **eight priority** areas for cooperation in the Blue Economy: